

Episode 6: Reunion and Forgiveness

Based on Qur'an, Surah Yusuf (12) : 58-101

The famine Yusuf had foreseen arrived, striking the whole region, including Canaan, where his father and brothers lived. Yusuf's brothers came to Egypt to buy grain, and without realizing it, stood face to face with Yusuf himself — who recognized them at once, while they did not recognize him at all (Qur'an 12:58).

Through a series of wisdom-laden events — including Yusuf's request that they bring Benjamin, his full brother, on their next visit (12:59-62), and Yusuf's plan to keep Benjamin with him (12:69-79) — Ya'qub's grief over losing Yusuf years earlier resurfaced in full. "Oh, my grief over Joseph," he said, his eyes turning white from the sorrow he suppressed (12:84). Yet Ya'qub never despaired of Allah's mercy (12:87).

When Yusuf's brothers returned and pleaded humbly for aid, Yusuf could no longer hold back. He asked them, "Do you know what you did with Joseph and his brother when you were ignorant?" (12:89). When they asked in astonishment, "Are you indeed Joseph?", he answered with compassion, "I am Joseph, and this is my brother. Allah has certainly favored us" (12:90).

With extraordinary magnanimity, Yusuf said to the very brothers who had once wronged him, "No blame will there be upon you today. Allah will forgive you" (12:92). He then sent his shirt to be

placed over his father's face, whose eyes had lost their sight from years of grief — and Ya'qub's sight was restored (12:93, 96).

The story reaches the moment foretold since Episode 1: Yusuf's entire family gathered in Egypt, and his parents bowed before him, fulfilling the dream of his childhood. Yusuf said, "O my father, this is the explanation of my vision of before. My Lord has made it reality" (12:100). He closes his own account with a deeply humble prayer, asking to be caused to die as one submitting to Allah and joined with the righteous (12:101).

Reflection: sincere forgiveness — not revenge — is the pinnacle of a prophet's character. The long patience of Yusuf and Ya'qub ultimately gave way to a joy far greater than the suffering they endured, a living proof of Allah's promise that "with hardship comes ease."

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